EMBRACE UNCERTAINTY

A BDD team knows that they won't know everything upfront, no matter how long they spend writing specifications. As we discussed earlier, the biggest thing slowing developers down in a software project is understanding what they need to build.

Rather than attempting to lock down the specifications at the start of the project, BDD practitioners assume that the requirements, or more precisely, their *understanding of* the requirements, will evolve and change throughout the life of a project. They try to get early feedback from the users and stakeholders to ensure that they're on track, and change tack accordingly, instead of waiting until the end of the project to see if their assumptions about the business requirements were correct.

Very often, the most effective way to see if users like a feature is to build it and show it to them as early as possible. With this in mind, experienced BDD teams prioritize the features that will deliver value, will improve their understanding of what features the users really need, and will help them understand how best to build and deliver these features.

ILLUSTRATE FEATURES WITH CONCRETE EXAMPLES

When a team practicing BDD decides to implement a feature, they work together with users and other stakeholders to define stories and scenarios of what users expect this feature to deliver. In particular, the users help define a set of concrete examples that illustrate key outcomes of the feature (see figure 1.7).

These examples use a common vocabulary and can be readily understood by both end users and members of the development team. They're usually expressed using the *Given ... When ... Then* notation you saw in section 1.3.2. For instance, a simple example that illustrates the "Transfer funds between a client's accounts" feature might look like this:

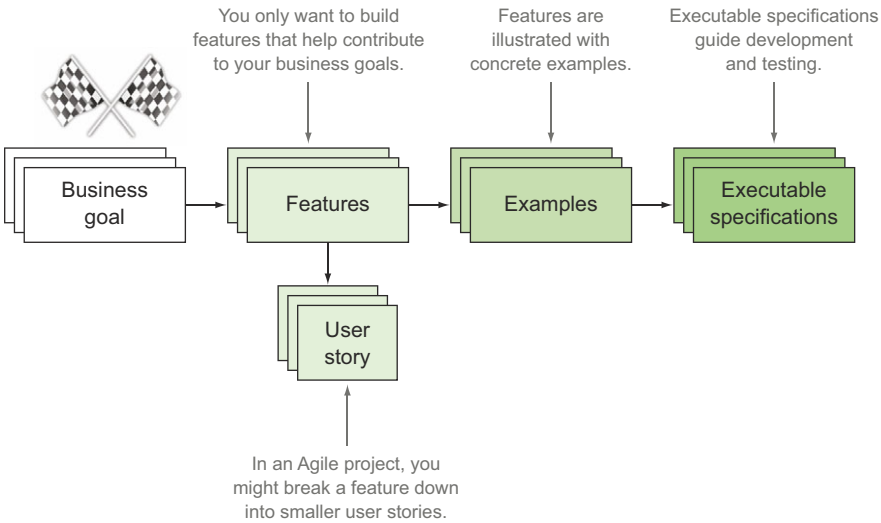


Figure 1.7 Examples play a primary role in BDD, helping everyone understand the requirements more clearly.